
Student Teaching Welcome and details

1 message

Borys, Zen <zborys@warner.rochester.edu>

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To: "Garcia, Piter" <pgarcia8@u.rochester.edu>, "Piter Garcia (RIT Student)" <pzg8794@rit.edu>, Derek Romig <derek.romig@greececsd.org>

Cc: Sue Maddamma <suemaddamma@gmail.com>, "Borys, Zen" <zborys@warner.rochester.edu>

Hi All (Piter, Derek, Sue, and me):

Apologies in advance – I know this is long. It's meant to serve as more of a reference. Please reach out with questions and concerns. The most important detail is to set up a time to meet so we can discuss the placement.

Derek, I hope that you've had a great start to the new year and semester! I'd like to begin this message by thanking you most sincerely, for agreeing to host Piter Garcia in your classroom this Spring. As one of Piter's University Supervisors, I'll work with you and Piter, to make the experience a positive one for Piter, your students, and you. I'm reaching out by e-mail during the early part of the field experience to schedule a "meet and greet" type meeting so that we (Piter, Derek, Sue, and myself) can get to know each other and discuss the expectations and needs for the placement. Piter, I'm going to ask you to work with Mr. Romig and suggest times that fit your schedule and then I can send a zoom link once we choose one that works for all. This placement involves two supervisors as Piter is earning a certification in computer science and inclusion, myself focused on computer science and Sue Maddamma focused on inclusion). We will work together as much as possible but there will be unique criteria specific to each program. I also want to share some general information about placement expectations; to find out if you've any questions for me; and to make sure we start getting on the same page regarding needs for the internship and your classroom.

GENERAL INFORMATION AND EXPECTATIONS

I've attached a graphic model of our internship process, which shows that the first internship consists of 150+ hours of observation and assistantship, with a gradual release of responsibility toward a five-week (25 days) student teaching assignment later in the semester (admittedly imperfect - it shows a fall start date and 100 hours, but it provides a general sense of the trajectory of the program and we are shifting to start in the Spring). During the semester, our students take up to 9 credits of coursework alongside their placements, which is why it's important that we move gradually and systematically regarding classroom responsibilities. Our programs aren't like others that have candidates take most or all their coursework before student teaching. Rather, we place students in schools alongside their coursework, to optimize opportunities for them to apply what they're learning in one context to the other. That said, teaching candidates don't necessarily spend all day, every day, in their field placements. Instead, they work with their SBTE's to arrange days and times that allow them consistency with particular classes and subject areas and provide some flexibility to make sense of what they're learning during their field placements and complete other required coursework.

The first task that we'll ask Piter to initiate with you is the creation of a formal letter of expectations, which dictates your schedule for the semester and anticipates specific roles of the SBTE, teaching candidate, and supervisors. The target date for submitting the letter of expectations is two weeks after the placement begins. Candidates are *not permitted* to go past the observation and assistantship phase on to their five-week student teaching phase, until they submit this letter and pass their field experience evaluation. I will also schedule an observation/meeting with you and Piter towards the end of the internship to ensure that all parties are on the same page moving into student teaching, to revise any points on the letter of expectations

if needed, and to discuss specific needs and interests that the candidate-SBTE-supervisor relationship might fulfill.

Our student teaching handbook lays out criteria for this letter of expectations, as well as specific roles for candidates, supervisors, and SBTEs. I'd encourage you to give it a read-through, to aid in communicating and clarifying expectations for the semester: <https://www.warner.rochester.edu/sites/default/files/2025-09/StudentTeachingHandbook%20-%202025-26.pdf>

The field supervisor (me) is charged with two to three visits during the semester: one during the field experience phase, and one to two during the five-week student teaching phase. It is similar for Sue, but we will work together and coordinate the details as they make sense for our unique roles. If questions or concerns emerge at any point outside these visits, please contact me for support, either by e-mail or telephone. I'm here to serve as a resource for you, as well. If you have any questions about the tools or materials that Piter brings to your classroom, or if there are other teaching resources to which I can connect you, please don't hesitate to ask.

CANDIDATE ASSESSMENT EXPECTATIONS

Alongside our placement model, I've attached a few documents that we use to evaluate candidates in their placements. One ("Warner_MidpointEval.pdf") is an assessment to be completed by you, Piter (as a self-evaluation), and UBTEs after the 150-hour observation and assistantship phase is complete. I would recommend that you and Piter sit down together with your completed documents, put them side by side, and use them to discuss your perceptions of progress to that point, as they can be effective tools for making sure you're seeing eye to eye, or for negotiating expectations moving forward. Please submit your copy of this form to me, by e-mail after you've had that conversation. The five weeks of student teaching cannot begin until this form is submitted.

The second assessment document ("Warner_CPAST_Rubric.docx") is Piter's final student teaching assessment. In order to reliably assess Piter's performance, it's important for all evaluators to participate in a brief online training program on understanding and using the CPAST. It shouldn't take longer than 60 to 90 minutes. At the end of the training, you'll answer 10 questions to verify your understanding of the assessment rubric. If you miss two questions, three additional questions are given, to make sure that respondents receive an 85% or higher (which is the target inter-rater reliability score). If you do not receive an 85% or above, you will be asked to take the training again; but know that repeated trainings contain the same content and assessment questions as the first effort. At the end of the training, you'll need to enter your name and affiliated university (ours may be listed either as "University of Rochester" or "Rochester University"), so that we have record of your completion. The training is accessible here: https://osu.az1.qualtrics.com/jfe/form/SV_cC8iDwgJ6JKLI7D

At the end of the placement and once you and I take the CPAST training, all of us – you, Piter, and myself – will participate in a three-way conference where we individually rate Piter's performance, discuss ratings, work to reach consensus scores for each assessment category, and articulate goals for Piter's growth as a teacher. I've included another document ("Warner_CPAST_ExamplesOfEvidence.docx") that explains what kinds of evidence might be associated with what kinds of rubric scores, as an optional resource for you all to consider (it is used during the online training for CPAST). Piter, you *will* need to self-assess using the CPAST at the end of the placement, but you do not need to take the training, as only the supervisor's and cooperating teacher's scores count toward your student teaching evaluation. I will facilitate the three-way conference via Zoom toward the end of the placement. After the three-way conference, I will submit the consensus score form, and Derek will submit her CPAST rubrics (with any notes to consider) to me.

Derek, to submit the midpoint assessment form, just download it, fill it out, and save the filename in this format: "Garcia_Romig_Spring2026MIDPOINT.pdf". Then, send the completed forms to me at: zborys@warner.rochester.edu.

MORE SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

During the initial 150+ hours of assistantship, you and Piter should feel free to build in whatever collegial experiences you see fit, given that the student's primary roles are to: (1) study learning, teaching, curriculum, and classroom/school context, as a novice "teacher-researcher;" and (2) support you in planning, teaching, assessing students, and building your classroom community, at a scale that makes sense for someone new to the classroom. These kinds of experiences could include tutoring individuals or small groups of students, assisting with assessments and evaluation, gathering and creating instructional resources, co-teaching lessons or lesson segments, and the like. Candidates are encouraged to immerse themselves in their classroom/school communities, and they often do so by participating in meetings, school-based professional development, special projects or extracurricular activities that their SBTEs may be involved in, et cetera.

As for the five-week student teaching phase, it is assumed that interns gradually will take on some instructional responsibilities up to that point, to avoid a hard, awkward transition from the assistantship phase to instruction. It also is assumed that interns will spend 25 instructional days in the school during this phase, though the number of required preps and course sections taught is flexible, depending on your and Piter's needs and interests. Co-teaching experiences are especially welcome, where you both design, implement, and assess instruction together; or you might opt for an approach where Piter assumes primary instructional responsibility for one of your classes. It's up to you both, depending on your expectations, circumstances, and comfort levels.

One caveat: in this semester's methods course, Piter will be responsible for developing and teaching a series of lessons designed to incorporate research-based practices or content explored during their methods classes. After practicing elements of that lesson in the methods course and modifying it based on classmates' and instructor's feedback, Piter is asked to implement it in your classroom as well. That said, your feedback and guidance are welcome to ensure that the content appropriately fits into your curriculum. I also hope that, when possible, you'll provide Piter with written, formative feedback on teaching during the last five weeks of his internship, so there is a record of your helpful advice to return to and reflect on later.

Again, thanks very much for agreeing to work with Piter this semester. Mentoring a new teacher is an important and challenging responsibility, and I'm glad you've decided to take it on! I recognize that this email contains a lot of information, so please reach out to me by e-mail or phone (cell: 585.259.9598) at any time about any matters related to Piter's internship.

All the best,
Zenon

4 attachments



Internship Graphic Model.pdf

227K



fieldexperience_eval.docx

17K



Warner_CPAST_ExamplesOfEvidence.docx

130K



WarnerSchool_CPAST_Rubric.docx

68K